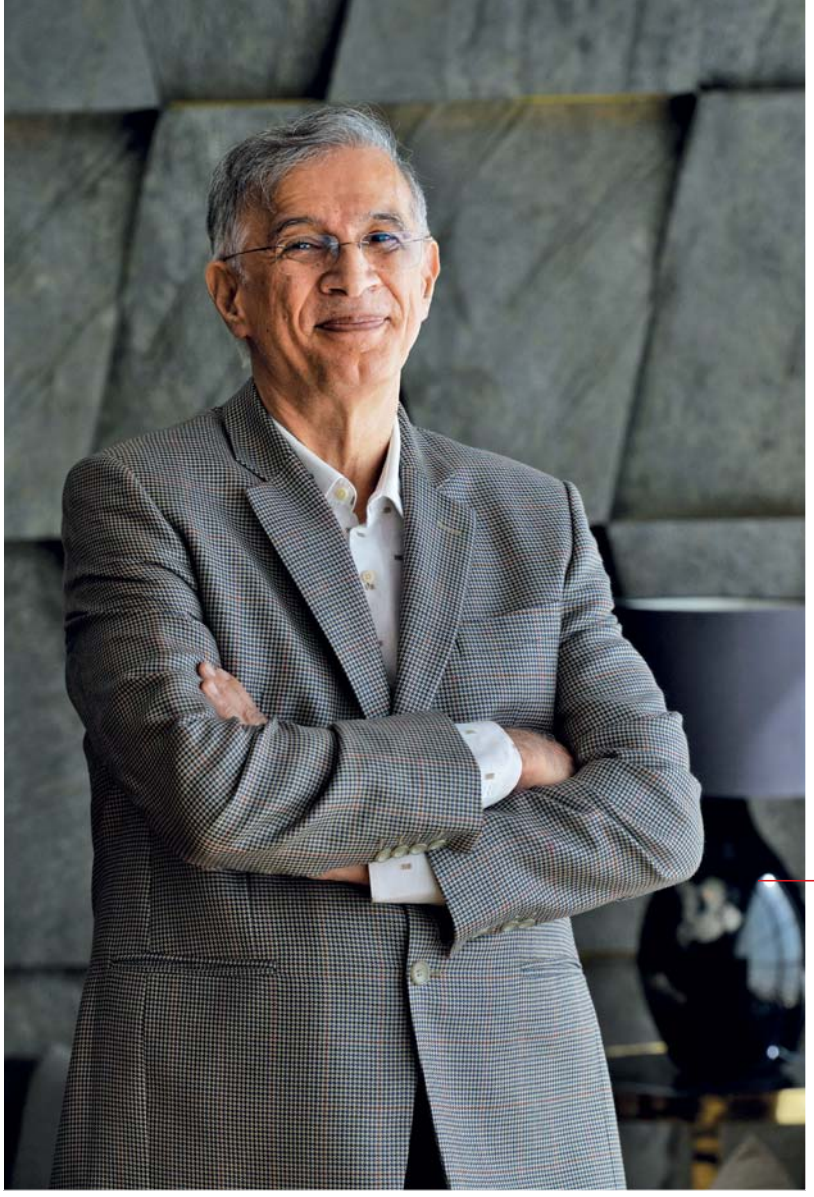


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"Every Rs 100 put into the real estate sector gives you 1,000 times more employment than putting it into the manufacturing sector"

NIRANJAN HIRANANDANI
Co-founder and Managing Director, Hiranandani Group

and hospitality. If you push health and education up, not only do you create jobs, but you also make your labour force more healthy, educated and employable.

● **SABNAVIS:** The budget is not a forum for creating jobs. Jobs are generally created in the private sector. In the organised sector, headcount growth has fallen from around 5 to 6 per cent [in pre-COVID times] to just 2 per cent in 2020-21 and 2021-22. That means jobs are not being created. We need to have growth, and growth is what is going to engineer greater employment opportunities. Growth gets affected because investment doesn't take place; investment doesn't take place because companies have surplus capacity; companies have surplus capacity because consumption is not growing; consumption is not growing because income is not growing; and income is not growing because jobs are not there. How to get out of this circle is the real question.

● **RANADE:** Let's remember that jobs are not going to be created by the Ambanis, Adanis, Tatas or Birlas or even in the armed forces. They are going to be created by small enterprises. If you want jobs to grow, enterprises need to grow. Half of industrial output, half of our exports and half of our employment is generated at the small-scale level and those units are struggling since pre-COVID times and certainly post-COVID too. There are 63 million enterprises in India, of which 99 per cent are small enterprises.

● **HIRANANDANI:** I'll focus on real estate. Twenty years ago, when I wanted 100 skilled workers, I would get 500 to come to my site. Today, when I want 100 skilled workers, I don't get 20. So, on the one side, you're talking about unemployment and, on the other side, I'm not getting skilled workers. Every Rs 100 put into the real estate sector gives you 1,000 times more employment than putting it into the manufacturing sector. If you want employment to take place and you want double-digit GDP growth for India, there is no other way but to do housing and infrastructure.

The truth of the real estate sector is that you haven't pushed it well enough. The NITI Aayog has said that if you want a $5 trillion economy, 20 per cent of that would come from real estate and infrastructure. The richest city in the country, Mumbai, has 50 per cent people living in the slums, and half of them cannot afford to buy a house of the size in which they stay. We don't have a programme by which we give them houses.